

FILM REVIEW

WHAT'S YOUR RAASHEE?

Zodiac Grilled

RATING ★ ★ ★ ☆ ☆ ☆

Director: Ashutosh Gowariker**Starring:** Priyanka Chopra, Harman Baweja

She's a feisty dancer as Leo, a committed doctor as Virgo, and a successful if unethical businesswoman as Libra. He's just Mr Average, whose only passion is to do an MBA in the US. That would explain the befuddled look on Harman Baweja's face throughout the movie. He's the only one in Bollywood who doesn't realise that women have become progressively smarter on screen. So there he is urging the good doctor to give up working in India's villages

and earn big bucks in the US. And there he is again cringing when he has to sign a pre-nuptial agreement with another. But then he's just a prop in a movie that exists solely to showcase Priyanka Chopra's growing acting talent. Ashutosh Gowariker, who is clearly unaware that marriages have migrated to tv, treats what could have been a light-hearted romantic comedy with an epic's weightiness, with at least one song picturised on each of the 12 different girls representing the zodiac signs. He does get the Gujarati zeitgeist right, from the mandatory *jhoola* in the living room to the much-prized NRI groom, from the comb in the brother's back pocket to

the guiltless celebration of gilt. But by the time Baweja insists to a prospective father-in-law with a dotty daughter who believes in reincarnation that he is an *asli mard*, no protein shakes and no steroids, his exhausted audience is wishing for a shot of both. **by Kaveree Bamzai**



IF YOU HAVE 120 MINUTES, attend a reading session of Roald Dahl's collection of stories, *Tales of the Unexpected*. On October 9 at British Council, Delhi.

FESTIVAL

Streaming CRAFT

The IIC Experience 2009, from October 8 to 14, explores the world of rivers through exhibitions, performances, films, poetry and cuisine.



The exhibition, *Along the Rivers of the World*, presents photographs of recent travels by photographers along the Irrawaddy, Amazon, Kamo, Malaprabha, Tungabhadra, Magyar, Tiber, Yangste, Vistula and Narmada.

Photographic exhibitions will depict natural landscapes, cultures and civilisations that developed and flourished along the world's rivers, including *Along the Banks of the Volga*



River that showcases late 19th century masterpieces from the National Library of Russia, St. Petersburg.

The Gandhi-King Plaza will host an exhibition of sculptures and installations, *Time: the Refreshing River*. There are works by Arpana Caur, Premlaya Singh, Shubhika Lal, Latika Katt (right) and Neeraj Gupta; curated by Keshav Malik. **by S. Sahaya Ranjit**

